back from Teheran about the 10th of next month, he went there to see Mr McNeill previous to his settling here as Consul.[45]

The weather here is now very pleasant, just cold enough to have the windows shut morning and evening and the sun warm in the middle of the day. This season is the grape harvest and I seldom go outside the walls of the town without seeing camels, mules and asses coming from all parts loaded with grapes. A great part of the grapes are consumed now, some are dried like the sultana raisins, and some are half dried by hanging the bunches on strings fastened across the ceiling from side to side of the rooms, (much as they hang oat cakes in Lancashire). In poor peoples houses the ceiling is sometimes covered with these grapes and they keep pretty fresh all thro' the winter. And a great part is made into wine for amongst the upper and middling classes of Persians I should think two thirds drink wine and one third did not. They also make of the ripe grapes a sweet syrup very much like treacle and of unripe grapes they express the juice and use it for making shirbets and also in stews and made dishes, the Persians are as fond of made dishes as the French are.

You may recollect that Charles brought out with him in the year 1835 three grey-hounds. Two of these, the two brown ones, were spoilt by being coupled together on the road. the black one is a fine dog but he also was much injured by the journey. Their sons and daughters are now in Mr Bonham's possession and they say nothing escapes them. I intend to go out and see them run tomorrow if nothing prevents me, and if we have the luck to find a hare which at this season are not numerous in this neighbourhood.

Should the Zoological society refuse to accept the two birds I have sent home, you can give them to any one you please or keep them yourself. I do not see why these birds should not breed in England and become numerous. The pheasant is said not to be originally a native of England but to have been brought from the neighbourhood of the river Phasis in Georgia.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tabreez, January 30, 1838*

If you are interested about Persia, and I can scarcely think that you are not, pray read Marius travels, particularly his "second journey" this book gives a better general idea of the country than any thing else I have seen, and also get a good map of Persia, for the upper provinces Montieths is the best, for the

[45] The British Army List for 1838 has Majors G. P. Cameron and George Woodfall accredited to Persia. The latter is also mentioned by the American missionary, Justin Perkins, in his *Residence of eight years in Persia among the Nestorian Christians,* Andover, 1843, as are also Dr. Riach, physician for the embassy; Abbott, later consul at Teheran; Nisbit, financial agent at Tabriz; and Bonham, consul at Tabriz. Curiously, the name of Edward Burgess nowhere occurs in Perkins's account. Col. MacIntosh does not appear in the British Army List. McNeill was the new ambassador to Persia.

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